

155 Grow beans on a teepee

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MINS

One of the easiest ways to grow runner beans in a small space is by training them up a pot-plant teepee. It's really easy to do, and you'll be amazed at the harvest your plants produce.

What you need

- 4 garden stakes
- Wire or string
- Large pot
- Seed compost
- Trowel
- Bean seeds
- Watering can



1 Fill a large plant pot with seed compost. Insert four stakes into the soil, then tie the ends together in a teepee shape.



2 Make a small hole at the base of each stake with your finger. Plant one bean by each stake. Cover with soil and water well.



3 As your plants grow, guide their stems up the stakes. You may need to tie them in loosely with twine to start.



4 Soon your beans will climb up the stakes by themselves. Keep them watered well in dry weather—misting them helps, too!

156 Watch a plant climb

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Many plants use tendrils to climb. Look at sweetpeas and you'll see thin, green "fingers" coiled tightly around whatever they touch. Watch how they do this over several days.

Curly
tendrils

Sweetpea
flower

